



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

yugapat tu pralīyante yadā tasmin mahātmani | 1.54a
tadā-ayaṃ sarvabhūtātmā sukhaṃ svapiti nirvṛtaḥ || 54 || 1.54c
tamo 'yaṃ tu samāśritya ciraṃ tiṣṭhati sa.indriyaḥ | 1.55a
na ca svaṃ kurute karma tadā-utkrāmati mūrtitaḥ || 55 || 1.55c
yadā-aṇumātriko bhūtvā bījaṃ sthāṣnu carīṣṇu ca | 1.56a
samāviśati saṃśṛṣṭas tadā mūrṭiṃ vimuñcati || 56 || 1.56c

— Manusmṛti, 1.5. Excursus: Cosmic Cycles (Chapter 5), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

When the universe dissolves back into the Great Soul, the “mahatmani,” all beings, enveloped in that Soul, rest in blissful slumber. This isn't a terrifying void, but a state of pure potential, a cosmic exhale after an era of creation. Think of it as the deep, restorative sleep you experience after a long, productive day, a necessary pause before the next burst of activity.

During this period of cosmic rest, the text describes existence as being cloaked in darkness, “tamas,” and remaining for a long time with the senses. The individual soul, still retaining its subtle essence, doesn't actively engage in karma. It's a period of latency, where potential energy gathers, awaiting the next phase. Then, the soul, reduced to an infinitesimal seed, merges with the collective, ready to sprout again. This seed contains both the potential for stillness (“sthasnu”) and movement (“carisnu”), reflecting the dual nature of existence. This merging allows the soul to shed its previous form, preparing for a new manifestation in the next cycle.

This ancient wisdom offers profound insights for your modern life. Recognize that endings are inherent to beginnings. Just as the universe undergoes cycles of creation and dissolution, so too do your personal experiences. Embrace periods of rest and introspection, allowing yourself to be enveloped in the “tamas” – the quiet darkness – where you can gather strength and clarity. Understand that apparent inactivity can be a potent period of preparation, a time for your inner seed to gather the necessary energy for future growth. Don't fear endings, but see them as opportunities to shed old forms and embrace new possibilities. Acknowledge that even in the midst of chaos or uncertainty, there is a deeper rhythm, a cosmic breath that sustains all of existence. The small “seed” within you is powerful, containing the potential for immense growth and transformation.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What old forms are you clinging to that prevent you from embracing the next cycle of your life, and how can you find peace in the periods of apparent inactivity?